Imperial College London
BUSINESS SCHOOL

Candidate Name:
CID Number:

Undergraduate BEST Examinations 2011/2012

B.Sc., B.Eng. and M.Eng. Examinations 2011/2012

For internal Students of Imperial College of Science Technology and Medicine.
This paper also forms part of the examination for the Associateship.

PROFESSIONAL ENGINEERING (BS0814)

Thursday 31st May 2012; 10:00 – 11:00

SEAT: 103

CLOSED BOOK

Instructions

Please complete your name and CID number in the box provided at the top of this question paper. This is to ensure all question papers are collected at the end of the examination as question papers are not allowed to be removed from the examination hall. This paper will not be used for marking purposes in any way and so you should ensure that you enter all of your answers on the answer sheet provided.

The system for multiple choice marking is as follows:

You score 1 point for each correct answer.

A quarter point is deducted for each incorrect answer.

You score zero for each blank answer.

Only provide **ONE** answer per question

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You score 1 point for each correct answer.
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You score zero for each blank answer.
You must choose **ONLY ONE** answer per question.

1. Which of the following defines the features to describe correctly a firm's competitive position?

   A. The competitive arena that is valuable and unique to the firm.
   B. The competitive arena and activities that are valuable and unique to the firm.
   C. The activities that are valuable and unique to the firm.
   D. The activities that are valuable for the firm.
   E. The competitive arena.

2. Which of the following statements about a firm's competitive strategy is <u>not</u> correct?

   A. Strategy is about defining how to perform similar activities better than competitors.
   B. Strategy is about producing products more effectively.
   C. Strategy is about defining schemes for specific actions.
   D. Strategy is an approach to coordinate individual capital investment decisions.
   E. All of the above

3. Which of the following statements about the role of strategy is <u>not</u> correct?

   A. Strategy improves decision-making processes.
   B. Strategy assists managers to identify the range of alternatives to consider.
   C. Strategy provides managers with precise solutions.
   D. Strategy helps to improve performance by setting high aspirations.
   E. Strategy creates unity within the firm by communicating common goals.

4. Which of the following terms describes what business strategy is?

   A. A plan to achieve goals and objectives
   B. A pattern of objectives and goals
   C. A perspective driving every action
   D. The means by which firms achieve their goals
   E. All of the above

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5. Which of the following issues should be contained in a statement illustrating a firm's strategy?

   A. The industries where the firm is competing
   B. The customer segments that the firm is targeting
   C. The range of activities that the firm engages in
   D. The basis of competitive advantage
   E. All of the above

6. Which of the following is an important element contributing to strategy success?

   A. Formulation of simple and consistent long-term goals
   B. Profound understanding of industry and macro environment
   C. Objective appraisal of resources and capabilities
   D. Effective implementation into organizational structures and systems to marshal resources and capabilities
   E. All of the above

7. Which of the following statements about population demographic would you disagree with?

   A. Population demographic may influence the profitability of industries and therefore is a sixth force in the Porter's five forces of competition model.
   B. Change in population demographic can change demand for given products.
   C. Change in population demographic can influence industry's profitability through its effect on the five forces of industry structure.
   D. Population demographic is part of firms' macro-environment.
   E. None of the above.

8. An industry's profitability is more likely to be high when

   A. the combined strength of Porter's five forces of competition is high.
   B. the combined strength of Porter's five forces of competition is low.
   C. a new technology allows firms to introduce new product innovation.
   D. a new government regulation has imposed higher costs on the industry leader.
   E. all of the above reasons.

9. Which of the following pieces of information is sufficient for you to understand whether or not the rivalry among existing competitors in an industry undermines industry's profitability?

   A. The intensity of competition is low.
   B. Firms compete on price.
   C. Firms compete on differentiation.
   D. Industry growth is high.
   E. None of the above.

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16. The study of organisational behaviour INCLUDES

A. questions around adoption of appropriate reward strategies.
B. the study of possible effects of employee monitoring technologies on perceived empowerment.
C. the study of possible implications of organisational mergers.
D. only one of the above.
E. all of the above 3 points.

17. The process of globalisation has led to

A. a shift towards the services sector especially in developed economies of the world.
B. the use of information technology to control and influence individual attitudes and behaviours.
C. increased importance of understanding individual personalities within the workplace.
D. increased workplace diversity.
E. all of the above.

18. ONE of the below is NOT a characteristic of a Type A personality:

A. Competitive
B. Restless
C. Seldom impatient
D. Works fast
E. Aggressiveness

19. Within service organisations the issue of _____ is especially important, given the direct involvement of the _____ with the employees.

A. Personality, Clients
B. Emotional labour, Customers
C. Mood, Customers
D. Feelings, Clients
E. None of the above

20. Motivation involves _____ in the _____ of a goal, _____ over a period of time required for the completion of the goal.

A. Effort, Persisting, Direction
B. Effort, Direction, Persisting
C. Effort, Direction, Motivated
D. Persisting, Direction, Effort
E. None of the above

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21. Organisational culture is the shared set of _____ that influence how members relate to each other and cooperate to achieve organisational goals.

A. Beliefs
B. Expectations
C. Values
D. Norms
E. All of the above

22. Jack has been employed with ABC Corporation for about three years. His manager realises that Jack has the potential to work to a much higher standard. Drawing on Herzberg's two factor theory of motivation, how would the manager increase Jack's level of motivation?

A. Increase his sense of job security.
B. Empower him to make autonomous decisions.
C. Offer financial inducements.
D. Bring about changes in the company policies.
E. None of the above.

23. Sources of organisational culture include All but ONE of the following:

A. Organisational ethics
B. Organisational structure
C. The employment relationship
D. The organisation's profitability
E. Characteristics of organisational members

24. It is established in literature that organisational socialisation plays a key role in shaping the organisational culture embodied by the employee. ONE of the statements below is NOT a source of the organisational socialisation process that shapes the culture that the individual embodies:

A. Organisational practices
B. The advert that attracts the employee to work for the organisation
C. The leadership in place
D. The financial inducement
E. Peer group interactions

25. One of the below is NOT an internal trigger for organisational change:

A. Inadequate skills and knowledge base triggering training programmes
B. Appointment of new senior management
C. Innovations in the manufacturing process
D. Changes in customer requirements and tastes
E. Low performance and morale triggering job redesign

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